Newton School of Technology

MLH MAJOR LEAGUE HACKING

HACKTOBERFEST 2026 · HACK DAY · BENGALURU

DEVF8RGE

Finals orientation · Halloween edition

30–31 OCT · P3 BUILDING, S-VYASA · SATTVA GLOBAL CITY

HACKING STARTS IN

03	:	27	:	30
HRS		MIN		SEC

WELCOME, HACKERS

You made the offline finals.

70
teams selected

200
hackers in the room

12
hours to build

One night. Let's build something spooky-good.

AI belongs to everyone.

This year's Hacktoberfest is about building with open-weight models and open-source AI. Tonight you do it in person, in one room, in one night.

Hacktoberfest

A month-long celebration of open source, every October, worldwide.

Hack Day

An in-person build event run by local communities, powered by MLH.

Your hosts: DevForge

The Dev Club of Newton School of Technology, Bengaluru. Find us by the Organising Committee ID.

STEP ONE

You're here. Check in.

1. Scan the code, or open mlh.com/checkin
2. Log in with your MLH account
3. Show your ID card at the desk

mlh.com/checkin

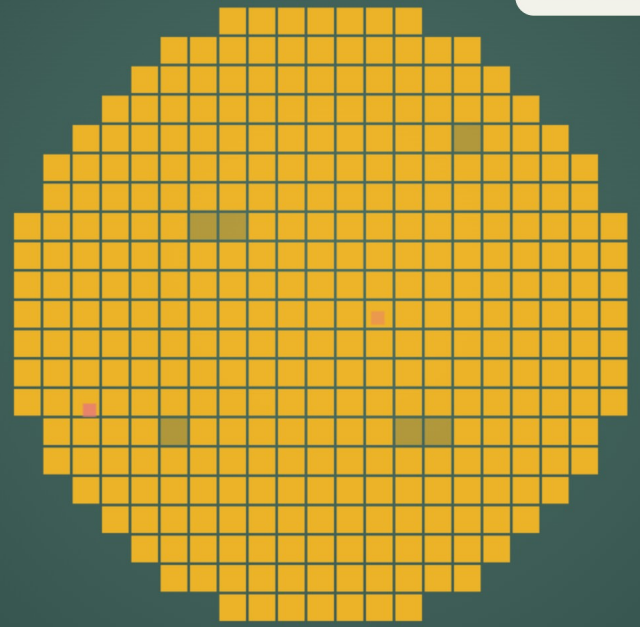
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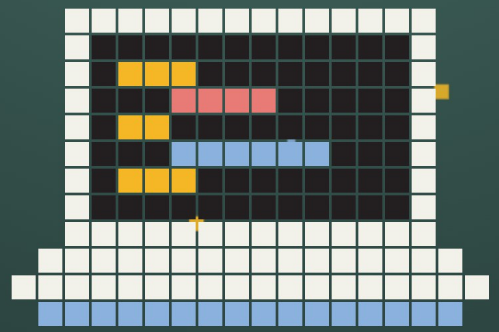
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CHAPTER 01

The Night

Must-knows · schedule · themes





IF YOU REMEMBER NOTHING ELSE

Six things you can't miss

1 **Hacking starts at 10:00 PM**
One 12-hour clock for every team

2 **Code freeze at 10:00 AM**
Later commits do not count

3 **Public repo + OSI licence**
From the very first commit

4 **All code written here**
Ideas can be ready. Code cannot.

5 **MLH + Consent Form**
Every single team member

6 **ID card on you, always**
Through the whole build

TONIGHT, HOUR BY HOUR

The schedule



Reporting & check-in

Hacking begins

Build · games · FIFA

Code freeze

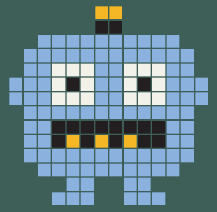
Demos & judging

Winners & prizes

The pumpkin tracks the real time. Two hard deadlines: 10 PM start and 10 AM code freeze.

PICK ONE

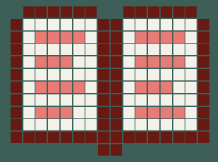
Three themes. One night.



THEME 01

AI for Open Source

Use AI to make open source easier to build, maintain and join.



THEME 02

Open Source for Education

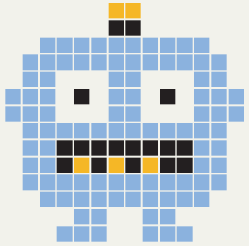
Open tools that help anyone learn, in any language, on any device.



THEME 03

Developer Productivity

Ship tools that save developers time and frustration.



THEME 01 / 03

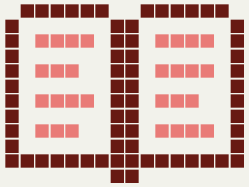
AI for Open Source

Use AI to make open source easier to build, maintain and join.

IDEAS TO STEAL

1. Bots that triage issues and review pull requests
2. Open models like Gemma or Llama, running locally
3. Tools that explain a codebase to newcomers

PAIRS WITH THE MLH OPEN-SOURCE AI CHALLENGE



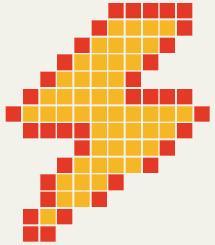
THEME 02 / 03

Open Source for Education

Open tools that help anyone learn, in any language, on any device.

IDEAS TO STEAL

1. Offline tutors for Indian languages
2. Guides that onboard first-time contributors
3. Open datasets and resources for classrooms



THEME 03 / 03

Developer Productivity

Ship tools that save developers time and frustration.

IDEAS TO STEAL

1. CLIs and GitHub Actions that automate chores
2. Smarter commits, reviews and release notes
3. Health checks that catch problems before they ship

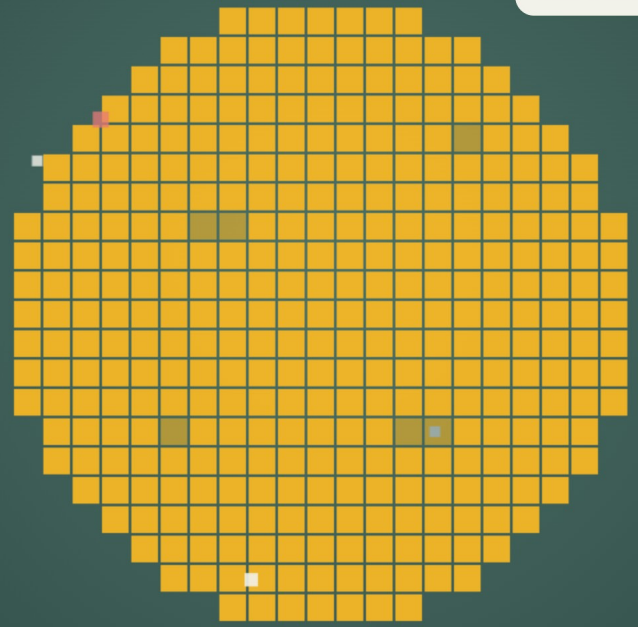
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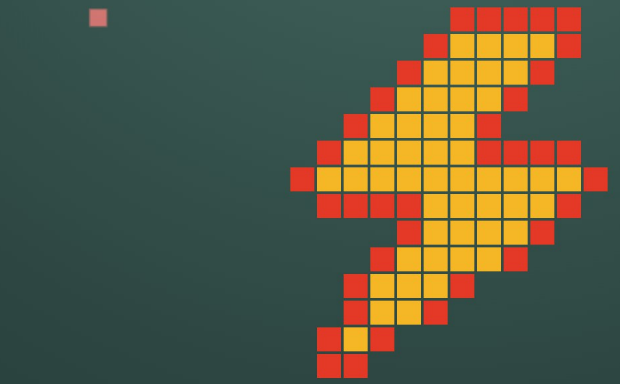
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CHAPTER 02

The Build

Rules · AI policy · judging · submission





CONTRIBUTING.MD

Rules of the build

01
Public repo
On GitHub, public from the start

02
OSI licence
For example MIT or Apache-2.0

03
Built here
All code written tonight; commits show it

04
README
What it does, setup, how to contribute

05
Credit everything
Libraries, datasets, templates, others' code

06
Your team, your PS
2–4 members on MLH, Round 1 problem statement

07
Fork, don't spam
No spam issues, PRs or comments

08
Stay safe
No real API keys, secrets or malware

QUICK QUIZ · SHOUT IT OUT

Allowed, or not allowed?

Copilot or ChatGPT helps write your code

If every member can explain it. Name it in your README.

ALLOWED

Running Gemma or Llama on your laptop

Open models are encouraged tonight.

ALLOWED

Bringing code you wrote last week

Ideas can be ready. Code cannot.

NOT ALLOWED

Planning your idea before 10 PM

Sketch, research, design. Just don't code.

ALLOWED

A real API key in your public repo

Never commit secrets. Ever.

NOT ALLOWED

Opening 20 PRs on random repos

Spam issues or PRs = disqualified.

NOT ALLOWED

A teammate who skipped MLH sign-up

Every member needs MLH + Consent Form.

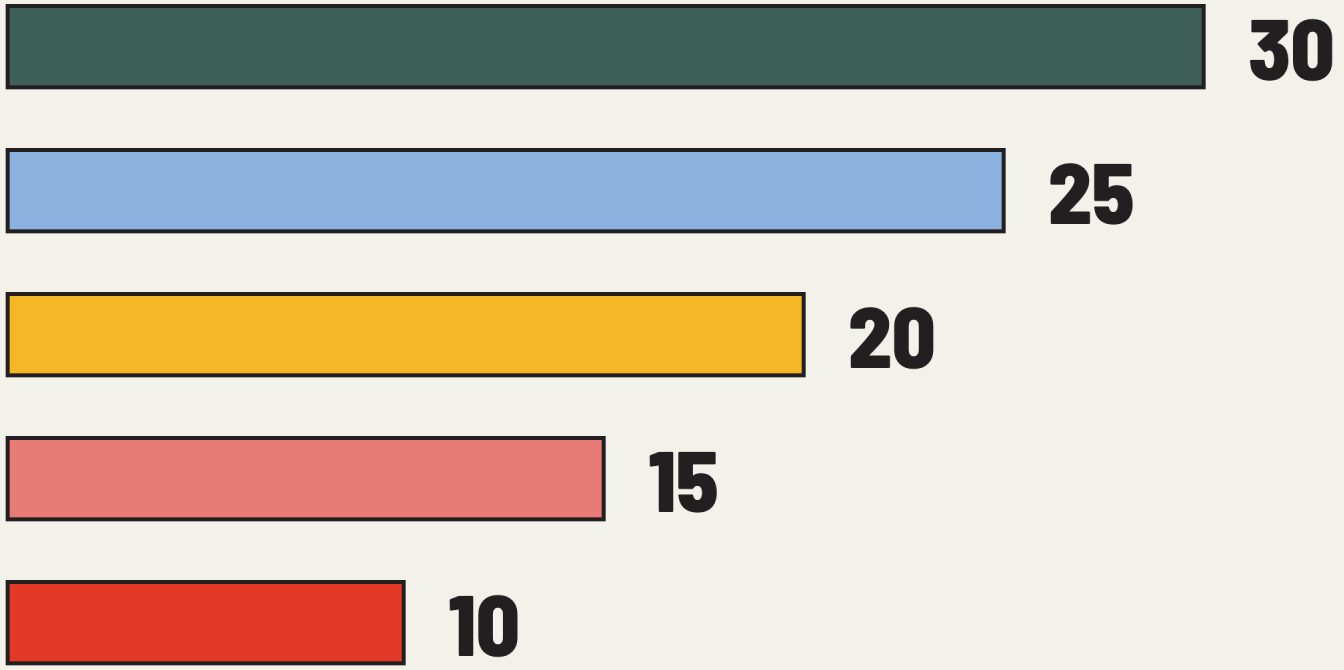
NOT ALLOWED

A FIFA break at 2 AM

Games and FIFA run all night.

ALLOWED

How you're scored



Open-source quality = README, licence, clean commits, open models.

DEMO TIME · 31 OCT

Five minutes on stage

3:00
LIVE DEMO

2:00
Q&A

- Your problem statement's difficulty is taken into account.
- Rehearse once before the code freeze.
- The judges' decision is final.

SHIP IT

Submit before 10:00 AM

- ✓ Public GitHub repo link
- ✓ OSI-approved licence in the repo
- ✓ README: setup + AI tools used
- ✓ A working demo
- ✓ Final submission form

HACKING STARTS IN

03	:	27	:	30
HRS		MIN		SEC

Anything pushed after 10:00 AM does not count.

THE HARD LINE

How to get disqualified

- **DQ** Pre-written code, or code copied without credit
- **DQ** A member not on MLH, or without the Consent Form
- **DQ** Spamming issues, PRs or comments on public repos
- **DQ** Real secrets, real malware, or publishing to npm or PyPI
- **DQ** Breaking the Code of Conduct or the venue rules
- **DQ** Missing the final submission before code freeze

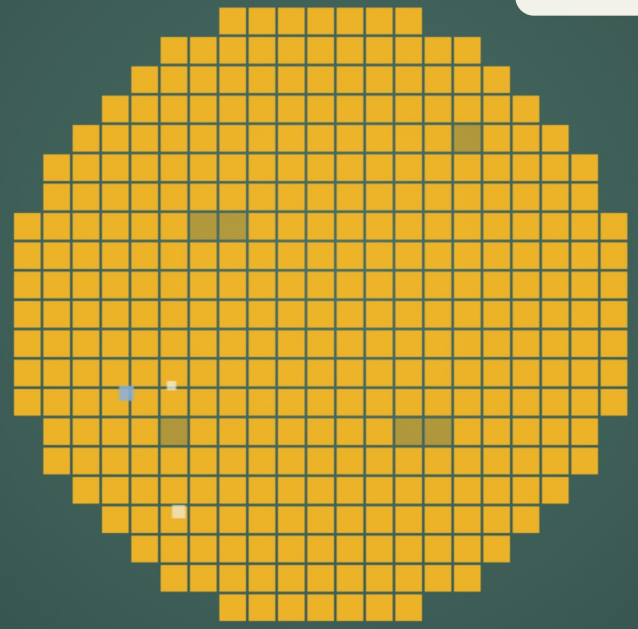
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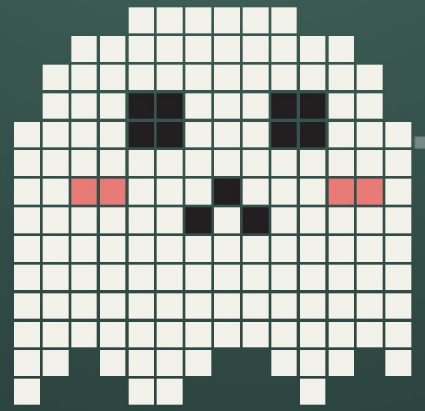
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CHAPTER 03

The Venue

Where you can go · how we behave





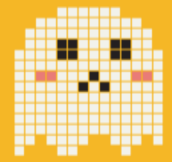
Where you can be tonight

Ground floor and 2nd floor only. The 6th floor opens only when an organiser announces it.

Every other floor: off-limits.

No exceptions.

6	🕒	ONLY WHEN ANNOUNCED
5	🔒	OFF-LIMITS
4	🔒	OFF-LIMITS
3	🔒	OFF-LIMITS
2	✓	OPEN · HACK HERE
1	🔒	OFF-LIMITS
G	✓	OPEN · HACK HERE



CODE OF CONDUCT

Be someone people want to hack with

DO

- Follow the MLH Code of Conduct and venue rules
- Respect every hacker, volunteer, mentor, judge and staff member
- Keep your ID on you and stay in the event area
- Keep the venue clean; care for furniture and power points

DON'T

- Leave laptops or phones unattended
- Harass, discriminate or disrupt
- Smoke, drink or bring prohibited substances
- Public displays of affection: keep it professional
- Wander onto floors that aren't open

MLH CODE OF CONDUCT

A safe space for everyone.

See something wrong? Tell a volunteer or organiser right away, or email **incidents@mlh.io**. Organisers may remove anyone who breaks it.



mlh.io/code-of-conduct

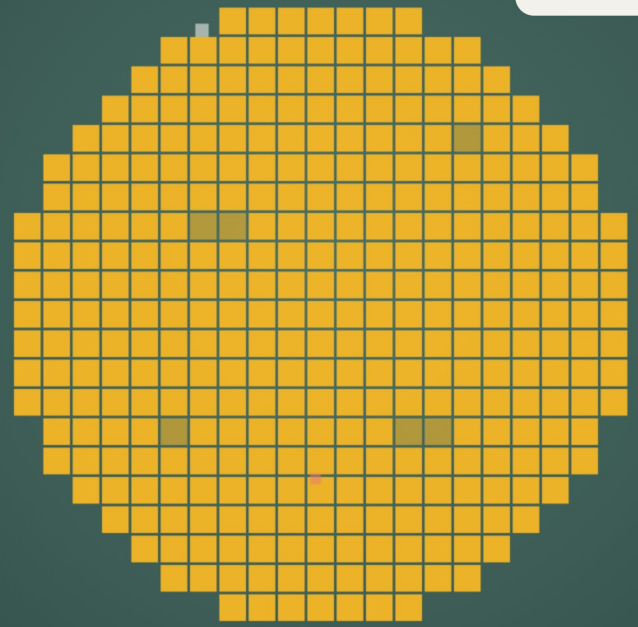
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CHAPTER 04

Treats

Prizes · perks · help · no tricks





PRIZE POOL

₹25K

for the teams that ship the best open source tonight.



01

Cash prize

02

Arduino chip

03

Goodies & stickers

ALL NIGHT

Games, FIFA & game nights

MLH CHALLENGE

Best Open-Source AI Project

Build an original project that uses open-source or open-weight AI.

WIN AN MLH + DEV SWAG BAG

Try Gemma

mlh.link/hackdays-gemma-demo

Challenge page

mlh.com/opensource-ai

HELP & FREE STUFF

Stuck at 3 AM? We've got you.

ASK, ANYTIME

- Any volunteer on the floor
- Anyone with an Organising Committee ID
- The official WhatsApp group
- MLH Discord: 100,000+ hackers

MLH Discord

mlh.link/Discord

Partner credits

hacktoberfest.com/my/promos

Write it up on DEV

mlh.link/dev-hacktoberfest

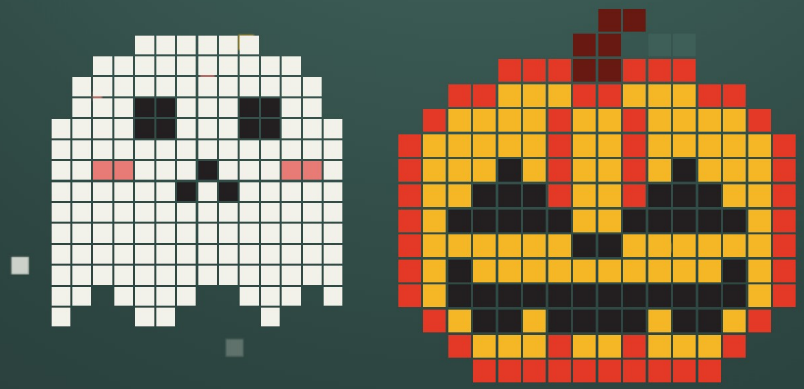
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```
$ git commit -m "let's go"
```

Happy hacking.

Hacking starts at 10:00 PM.
Code freeze at 10:00 AM.



Tell us about your Hack Day

mlh.link/gemma-hack-day-feedback